Most owners run their business by feel. They solve problems in the order they arrive, react when the numbers have already turned bad, and work harder when the plan stops working.

Steer, Don't Guess offers another way. The Jirgenson Model takes the logic engineers use to steer ships, aircraft and factories and turns it into a practical routine for a small business, a family budget or a teenager's savings: write down your goals in the order you would give them up, measure honestly where you are, see the gap and its zones, find the levers you really control, and set a rhythm of checks.

Through the story of Andrew and his coffee shop, The Corner, you will learn to:

- separate goals from methods and decide what you protect to the last;
- set red lines before a crisis, not in the middle of one;
- forecast instead of reacting, and change the plan without abandoning the goal;
- work back from a distant goal to what needs doing this week.

Every chapter works on three levels, from everyday examples to formulas. The appendices contain a canon and a prompt that turn a language model into an assistant working by the model: in a blind test it scored 88.9 out of 100, against 55.9 without them.

Martin Jirgenson is a researcher in control systems and a management practitioner. He builds tools that turn the laws of control theory into everyday practice for business and life.

STEER, DON'T GUESS

MARTIN JIRGENSON

THE JIRGENSON MODEL

Steer, Don't Guess

Setting Priorities, Reading the Numbers and Correcting Course in Business and Life

Martin Jirgenson